

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

What you need to evidence for a Visitor Visa - there's no fixed minimum balance

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

There's no fixed published minimum

Like the UK Standard Visitor route (and unlike Canada's own Study Permit, which does have a published formula - see that visa type's own documents if you're applying for both), the Visitor Visa has no fixed minimum bank balance set out in IRPA/IRPR. What matters is whether your evidence shows you can support yourself and any dependants for the trip without working in Canada, and cover your return or onward travel.

What “sufficient funds” means in practice

- Enough to cover accommodation, subsistence, and activities for the length of your stay
- Consistent with your stated income and travel plans
- If a third party is covering costs, clear evidence of that arrangement and their own means, ideally with a Letter of Invitation

Acceptable evidence

- Bank statements covering a reasonable recent period, not a single-day snapshot
- Pay stubs or an employer letter confirming income
- Savings, fixed deposits, or investment statements
- A host or sponsor's financial evidence plus a signed Letter of Invitation, if someone else is funding the trip

Red flags

- A large, recent, unexplained deposit shortly before applying
- A balance inconsistent with the applicant's stated occupation or income
- Financial evidence that covers the trip on paper but leaves no plausible means afterward